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Memories of chaos at Capitol still fresh

Current and former lawmakers tell of terror — and genuine unity

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — At first, the only remarkable thing about Sept. 11, 2001, was the weather — a chill hint of fall under a brilliant blue sky.

“I remember walking to the office and it was a beautiful day,” said former Lowell representative Martin Meehan. As usual, he headed in from his Capitol Hill apartment a little before 7:30 a.m.

About an hour later, Worcester Representative Jim McGovern began his own walk to work from his home, stopping to drop off his son at a day-care center near the Capitol building. Ed Markey, then a Malden representative, was driving in from the Maryland suburbs.

On the other side of the Capitol complex, Edward M. Kennedy was waiting to greet first lady Laura Bush before she appeared at an education hearing he was

chairing. The other senator from Massachusetts, John Kerry, was heading to the Capitol for a meeting.

Shortly before 9 a.m., they and the rest of the nation began hearing bizarre reports: a plane had slammed into the North Tower of the World Trade Center in New York City.

Within the hour, after the other tower was hit and the Pentagon was struck, it became as clear as that cloudless sky that the nation was under terrorist attack. Chaos broke out in Washington as fears spread that the Capitol building or the White

House would be next.

For Massachusetts lawmakers and their staffs, the crisis was amplified. Two of the hijacked airliners departed from Boston, filled with local passengers and flight crew. Desperate for information, relatives and friends began frantically calling their representatives.

Before Sept. 11, partisan divisions ran deep. It was just nine months since a controversial Supreme Court ruling decided one of the closest presidential elections ever and many Democrats remained bitter.

UNITY, Page A5

Wu making new plan to boost housing

Tax breaks and changes to zoning are on table

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

Over her five years in office, Boston Mayor Michelle Wu has pledged to rein in the city’s sky-high cost of housing, to little avail. Rents continue to climb, construction has slowed, and residents continue to trickle away for places they can better afford.

Now, her administration is considering a host of changes in hopes of finally cracking the problem, including tax breaks for “high-priority” projects struggling for financing and zoning to encourage more affordable housing developments in key neighborhoods.

At the same time, housing officials are preparing to lower expectations for how much housing can realistically be built amid the current economic conditions.

A draft of the Wu administration’s new plan, obtained by the Globe, indicates the city hopes to permit 3,000 new housing units annually over her second four-year term. That’s fewer than the 13,000 she set out to build over her first four years in office, but roughly on pace with construction over the last 18 months.

Boston officials stressed the plan is preliminary — drafted by the city’s top housing officials, it has not been finalized by the mayor herself. But a draft was shared with developers and advocates last week, and it outlines how Wu might address one of Boston’s thorniest challenges in her

HOUSING, Page A7



MICHAEL M. SANTIAGO/GETTY IMAGES

‘I wanted to do music at the highest level possible. I knew that wasn’t happening in Boston.’

CLARK LACOSSADE, a rapper and producer who decided to stay in Atlanta

In pricey Boston, musicians must work hard to play



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Sophia Perez, a recent Berklee College of Music graduate, is thinking of moving to New York to get her break.

Hoping to get into the business, they face many obstacles

By Auzzy Byrdsell
GLOBE STAFF

Clark Lacossade was at a crossroads.

The rapper and producer, who goes by Clark D, was raised in Hyde Park and launched his career in Boston. He moved to Georgia in 2021 for an internship at a recording studio and planned to come home afterward. But after experiencing Atlanta’s thriving music industry, he decided to stay, concluding the South offered him the best shot at success.

“I wanted to do music at the highest

level possible,” he said. “I knew that wasn’t happening in Boston.”

Since moving, he’s earned six Grammy nominations and released six albums. He’s on a cross-country tour and has 120,000 monthly listeners on Spotify.

Lacossade is one of many Boston musicians who felt they had to leave town to seek fame and fortune. Artists say the music industry in Boston has always been tough — and is only getting tougher.

Since the pandemic, the obstacles for local musicians have multiplied. A slew of performance venues have recently closed, including Thunder Road, ONCE Lounge, and Hennessy’s Bar. At a time of tight budgets, government funding for arts programs has also

MUSICIANS, Page A7

Clancy jurors confirm lone holdout would not acquit

By Shelley Murphy and Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

The foreperson of the jury that couldn’t reach a unanimous verdict in Lindsay Clancy’s trial said a single holdout admitted he had reasonable doubt about her guilt, but refused to acquit her of killing her three children by reason of insanity, according to an NBC10 Boston report.

“He admitted he had reasonable doubt” after watching a videotaped interview of Clancy in April by a forensic psychologist who evaluated her for the prosecution, the foreperson told Sue O’Connell, an NBC10 commentator. “But he said, ‘I’m still not going to say she’s not guilty by reason of insanity.’”

NBC10 identified three jurors only by their first names. NBC Nightly News carried the local interviews and identified the jurors with their full names in its national broadcast as foreperson Roni Carlson, Paula Devlin, and Kellie Farina.

Farina and Carlson, reached at their homes, declined to comment. There was no answer at Devlin’s door.

The details about deliberations provided to O’Connell by the three jurors appear to bolster arguments made by Clancy’s attorney, Kevin Reddington. He urged the judge to remove the apparent holdout after jurors sent the judge a note Thursday indicating the holdout was not following his instructions on the law.

Plymouth Superior Court Judge William F. Sullivan said it would not be appropriate to inter-

CLANCY, Page A6

Governor Maura Healey signed an executive order that she said would effectively block new data centers unless they get local approval. **B1.**

Many Massachusetts businesses are worried again about tar-

iffs after President Trump introduced another batch. **B5.**

Lonnie Bunch III, secretary of the Smithsonian Institution, is resigning after facing years of attacks from the Trump administration. **A2.**

Thieves fled with four paintings from the Renoir Museum. **A3.**

The Patriots will kick off the NFL season against the Seahawks tonight after giving star cornerback Christian Gonzalez a record-setting extension. **C1.**

Little operations, big demand

Cottage bakers are finding a ready audience for bread and other baked goods prepared in their home kitchens. Thomas Generazio (right) of Mainstay Bakery in Scituate sells 250 loaves a week. **G1.**



THOMAS GENERAZIO

This is a stickup

Wednesday: Humidity’s back. High 76-81. Low 68-73.

Thursday: Maybe a T-storm. High 83-88. Low 62-67.

Sunrise: 6:18 Sunset: 7:05
Weather and Comics, G8-9.



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